

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 36

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1. Accord

Meaning: Agreement or harmony; to give or grant.

Tip to remember: Accord sounds like “a chord.” In music, chords sound good when they are in harmony. Accord means agreement or harmony.

Sentence: The two countries signed an accord to reduce trade barriers.

2. Ad hoc

Meaning: Created for a specific purpose or situation, not planned in advance.

Tip to remember: Think of “add hoc” as adding a quick temporary solution just for one problem.

Sentence: The committee formed an ad hoc group to solve the urgent issue.

3. Adhere

Meaning: To stick to something; to follow rules, beliefs, or principles.

Tip to remember: Adhesive sticks things together. Adhere means to stick physically or mentally.

Sentence: Students must adhere to the exam guidelines.

4. All-encompassing

Meaning: Including everything; very comprehensive.

Tip to remember: Encompass means to surround or include. All-encompassing means surrounding all parts of a topic.

Sentence: The professor gave an all-encompassing review of the course.

5. Aphorism

Meaning: A short, wise saying.

Tip to remember: Think of a compact sentence like “Actions speak louder than words.” That is an aphorism.

Sentence: The essay began with an aphorism about patience.

6. Benchmark

Meaning: A standard used for comparison or measurement.

Tip to remember: Think of a mark on a bench used as a reference point. A benchmark helps measure performance.

Sentence: The new model was tested against a standard benchmark.

7. **Blighted**
Meaning: Damaged, spoiled, or ruined.
Tip to remember: Blight is a disease that ruins plants. A blighted area or dream is damaged badly.
Sentence: The city had many blighted neighborhoods with abandoned houses.
8. **Content**
Meaning: Satisfied and not wanting more.
Tip to remember: GRE trick: content can mean information, but as an adjective it means satisfied.
Sentence: She was content with her simple but peaceful life.
9. **Debase**
Meaning: To lower the value, quality, or dignity of something.
Tip to remember: Debase means to bring something down to a lower base.
Sentence: Corruption can debase public trust in government.
10. **Disconcerting**
Meaning: Disturbing, confusing, or making someone uneasy.
Tip to remember: Disconcerting sounds like “disrupting concentration.” Something disconcerting disturbs your calm.
Sentence: The sudden silence in the room was disconcerting.
11. **Extant**
Meaning: Still existing; not destroyed or lost.
Tip to remember: Extant sounds like “exists.” If something is extant, it still exists.
Sentence: Few extant manuscripts from that period remain today.
12. **Facility**
Meaning: Ease or skill in doing something; also, a building or place for a specific purpose.
Tip to remember: GRE often uses facility to mean ease or natural skill. If you do something with facility, you do it easily.
Sentence: She learned new languages with remarkable facility.
13. **Fitful**
Meaning: Irregular, stopping and starting repeatedly.
Tip to remember: Think of sleep that comes in small fits and starts. That is fitful sleep.
Sentence: He had a fitful night of sleep before the exam.
14. **Incite**
Meaning: To encourage or stir up strong action, often negative.
Tip to remember: Incite sounds like “ignite.” Words can ignite anger or action.
Sentence: The speech incited the crowd to protest.
15. **Induce**
Meaning: To cause, persuade, or bring about.

Tip to remember: Think of inducing sleep: causing someone to sleep. Induce means cause something to happen.

Sentence: The medicine may induce drowsiness.

16. **Infelicity**

Meaning: An inappropriate or unfortunate expression, action, or mistake.

Tip to remember: Felicity means happiness or suitability. Infelicity means something unsuitable or awkward.

Sentence: The speech contained several verbal infelicities.

17. **Intelligible**

Meaning: Clear enough to be understood.

Tip to remember: Intelligible relates to intelligence. If your intelligence can understand it, it is intelligible.

Sentence: The professor made the complex theory intelligible to beginners.

18. **Makeshift**

Meaning: Temporary and used because nothing better is available.

Tip to remember: Makeshift means you make something shift into use for now. It is not permanent.

Sentence: They built a makeshift shelter after the storm.

19. **Onetime**

Meaning: Former; previous.

Tip to remember: Onetime means someone was something at one time in the past.

Sentence: The onetime champion now coaches young athletes.

20. **Opportunistic**

Meaning: Taking advantage of situations for personal benefit, often without principles.

Tip to remember: Opportunistic comes from opportunity. An opportunistic person grabs chances mainly for self-interest.

Sentence: His opportunistic behavior made his friends distrust him.

21. **Plausible**

Meaning: Seeming reasonable or believable.

Tip to remember: Plausible sounds like “possible.” A plausible explanation seems possible and believable.

Sentence: Her explanation was plausible, but it still needed evidence.

22. **Posturing**

Meaning: Acting in a way meant to impress or mislead others.

Tip to remember: Think of someone striking a fake pose to look powerful. That is posturing.

Sentence: The politician’s speech was mostly posturing, not real policy.

23. **Potent**

Meaning: Powerful, strong, or highly effective.

Tip to remember: Potent sounds like power. A potent medicine has strong effect.
Sentence: The article made a potent argument for educational reform.

24. **Redundant**

Meaning: Unnecessary because it repeats something already present.

Tip to remember: Think of saying the same thing again and again. That extra repetition is redundant.

Sentence: The editor removed redundant sentences from the essay.

25. **Sacrosanct**

Meaning: Too important or sacred to be changed or criticized.

Tip to remember: Sacro means sacred. Sacrosanct means treated as sacred and untouchable.

Sentence: In many democracies, freedom of speech is considered sacrosanct.

26. **Shrewd**

Meaning: Clever, practical, and good at judging situations.

Tip to remember: Think of a smart trader who quickly understands profit and risk. That person is shrewd.

Sentence: The shrewd investor avoided the failing company.

27. **Unadorned**

Meaning: Plain, simple, and not decorated.

Tip to remember: Adorn means decorate. Unadorned means without decoration.

Sentence: The room was unadorned but clean and peaceful.

28. **Valedictory**

Meaning: Related to saying farewell; a farewell speech or statement.

Tip to remember: Think of a valedictorian giving a farewell speech at graduation.

Sentence: Her valedictory speech thanked the teachers and classmates.

29. **Warranted**

Meaning: Justified, reasonable, or deserved.

Tip to remember: A warrant gives official reason for action. If something is warranted, there is good reason for it.

Sentence: The criticism was warranted because the report contained serious errors.

30. **Wistful**

Meaning: Sad and thoughtful because of longing or nostalgia.

Tip to remember: Think of looking at old photos and wishing for the past. That feeling is wistful.

Sentence: He gave a wistful smile while remembering his childhood.